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Spice up your Spotify

Customising Spotify desktop with Spicetify

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India was pretty late to join the Spotify party, but now that it's here, there's no denying how popular the music streaming app has become. It very quickly became a top contender in the music streaming category, quickly rising to match and even surpass existing players in the field such as YouTube Music, Amazon Prime Music, and even local services like Saavn and Wynk. Now, not everyone might have an issue with Spotify's overall theme and aesthetic, it's got a dark mode and a fairly clean interface, what more do you want really? But jokes aside, if you're looking to spice up Spotify, then this workshop is for you.

Introducing Spicetify, an open-source Spotify customisation tool that can allow you to customise and finetune Spotify to turn it into the perfect music streaming software for you. With Spicetify, you can change the colour scheme and theme of Spotify's UI. That's the simple bit, with Spicetify, you can do even more, such as installing custom apps within Spotify, installing custom extensions, and removing bloat from the desktop app. It should be noted that Spicetify is a command-line only tool. Meaning you'll need to cmd or Powershell on Windows in order to actually use Spicetify. This, unfortunately, also means that it's limited to the desktop app. In

this workshop, we'll be covering how you can use Spicetify to apply custom themes and skins to Spotify for Windows. Write in to us if you'd like us to cover more of Spicetify's capabilities in future articles. All that being said, let's get into how you can change Spotify's theme with Spicetify.

GETTING STARTED

First things first, you will need to install the Spicetify-cli, which is what

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Administrator: Windows PowerShell
Windows PowerShell
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Try the new cross-platform PowerShell https://aka.ms/powershell

Warning: PowerShell detected that you might be using a screen reader and has disabled PSReadline for compatibility purposes. If you want to re-enable it, run 'Import-Module PSReadline'.

PS C:\WINDOWS\system32> Invoke-WebRequest "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/khanhas/spicetify-cli/master/install.ps1" |
Invoke-Expression
Downloading https://api.github.com/repos/khanhas/spicetify-cli/releases/latest > OK
Extracting https://github.com/khanhas/spicetify-cli/releases/download/v1.2.1/spicetify-1.2.1-windows-x64.zip > OK
Extracting C:\Users\Manish\spicetify-cli\spicetify-1.2.1-windows-x64.zip into C:\Users\Manish\spicetify-cli > OK
Extracting C:\Users\Manish\spicetify-cli\spicetify-1.2.1-windows-x64.zip > OK
Installing C:\Users\Manish\spicetify-cli to the PATH environment variable... > OK
> OK
Run spicetify --help to get started.
PS C:\WINDOWS\system32>
  
```

it's officially called. There are two ways to go about this. The first is to go to the official GitHub page here: <http://dgit.in/spicetify> and download it. You will then need to extract this file to C:\Users\YOURUSERNAME\spicetify with .spicetify being the name of the folder you created. The alternative, and easier option, in our opinion, is to simply head on over to Windows Powershell and run the following command:

Invoke-WebRequest
"https://raw.githubusercontent.com/khanhas/spicetify-cli/master/install.ps1" |
Invoke-Expression

Running this command will both download and install Spicetify-cli onto your system. That's it, step one is now complete, let's move on.

RUNNING SPICETIFY-CLI

The next step is actually running Spicetify-cli. Like we mentioned above, Spicetify works entirely on cmd lines, so head on over to Powershell and simply input the command:

spicetify

This won't open anything, so don't panic, but it will generate a config.ini file in the .spicetify folder. This file is important for when it comes to actually applying the themes.

BACKUP DEFAULT SETTINGS

Spicetify consists of primarily user-made themes so it's very likely that a lot of them are broken. If you're planning to mess around with them yourself, then all the more reason to create a backup for the existing default settings of Spotify. This way, you can restore everything back to the way it

was with a single command if need be. In order to create a backup, input the following command.

spicetify backup apply
enable-devtool

Once that's done, if you have Spotify open, you will notice that it will restart, and with the light theme applied. This is Spicetify's default theme now. Now incase an applied theme is broken or something doesn't look right, you can simply use the restore command to go back to the default theme. The restore command is as follows.

spicetify restore

SETTING UP A SPICETIFY THEME

Now that you're done with installing and setting Spicetify-cli up, let's get to the good part, installing a Spicetify theme to spice up your Spotify